

Exp 11: Deploying a Zoho Creator Application from Development to Production Environment

1. Aim

To implement, execute, and verify a complete multi-stage Application Lifecycle Management (ALM) release pipeline in Zoho Creator by deploying schema modifications, component changes, and form updates from the isolated Development environment through the Staging environment and into the live Production environment.

2. Procedure

Phase A: Access Multi-Stage Environments Space

Step 1: Logged into the Zoho Creator developer workspace and navigated to the **Environments** dashboard located under the primary **DEPLOY** navigation category ("*Multi-stage deployment space to test and publish your application without affecting the production*").

Step 2: Verified the baseline environment configurations for the application *Vehicle Services & Repair Request* (VSR), which initially tracked baseline version 1.0 across both Stage and Production.

Phase B: Author Schema Updates in Development

Step 3: In the active Development environment, modified the application schema by updating the address structure and associated customer intake attributes within the `Service_Request_Form` component (comprising 5 modified component items).

Phase C: Promotion from Development to Stage Environment

Step 4: Clicked **Publish > Publish to Stage**. In the *Select Apps* modal, selected **Vehicle Services & Repair Request** (VSR) and clicked **Proceed**.

Step 5: In the *Staging — Publish to Stage Environment* configuration panel, entered release parameters:

- **Release Type:** Selected **Major** (*Enhancements & Updates*).
- **Application Version Increment:** Configured version upgrade from V1.0 → V2.0.
- **Maintenance Mode Notification:** Noted that the application is placed into temporary maintenance mode to safeguard database integrity during structural migration.
- **Email Notification:** Configured alert dispatch to `admin@pravinraj.me`.

Step 6: Confirmed the submission. Zoho Creator initiated asynchronous migration to the Stage environment and displayed the tracking confirmation dialog.

Step 7: Monitored deployment progress until the Environments dashboard updated, reflecting **Stage at Version 2.0** (Oct 06, 2026) while keeping Production at baseline Version 1.0.

Phase D: Promotion from Stage to Live Production Environment

Step 8: Having validated the schema updates in Stage, initiated production deployment by selecting **Publish** > **Publish to Production**.

Step 9: In the *Select Version — Publish to Production Environment* drawer, selected the validated staging version candidate (Title: "Changed the address field." — Vehicle Services & Repair Request v2.0, comprising 5 modified components).

Step 10: In the *Version — Publish to Production Environment* configuration dialog, evaluated publishing schedules:

- **Publishing Option:** Selected **Publish Now** to trigger immediate live deployment.
- **Timezone:** Set to (GMT+05:30) Chennai, Kolkata, Mumbai, New Delhi.
- **Notification:** Confirmed automated status email to admin@pravinraj.me.

Step 11: Clicked **Proceed** to initiate the production deployment push.

Phase E: Post-Deployment Audit & Verification

Step 12: Inspected the centralized Environments management console. Verified that both **Stage** and **Production** environments are fully synchronized at **Version 2.0** (Oct 06, 2026), with the dashboard reporting "No changes available", confirming 100% deployment completion.

3. Output

3.1 Selecting Application for Staging Promotion

The *Select Apps — Publish to Stage from Development* dialog showing the selected application entity *Vehicle Services & Repair Request* (VSR):

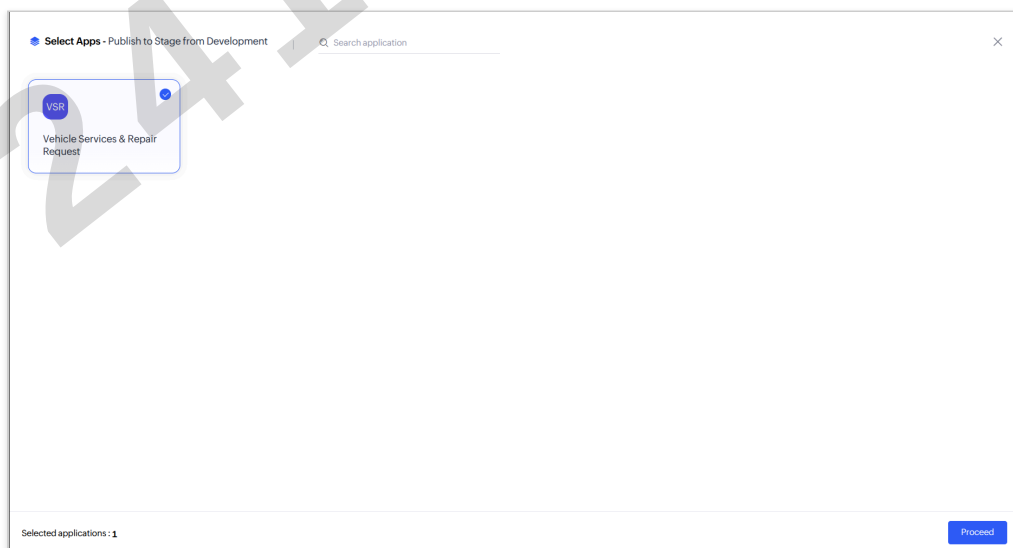
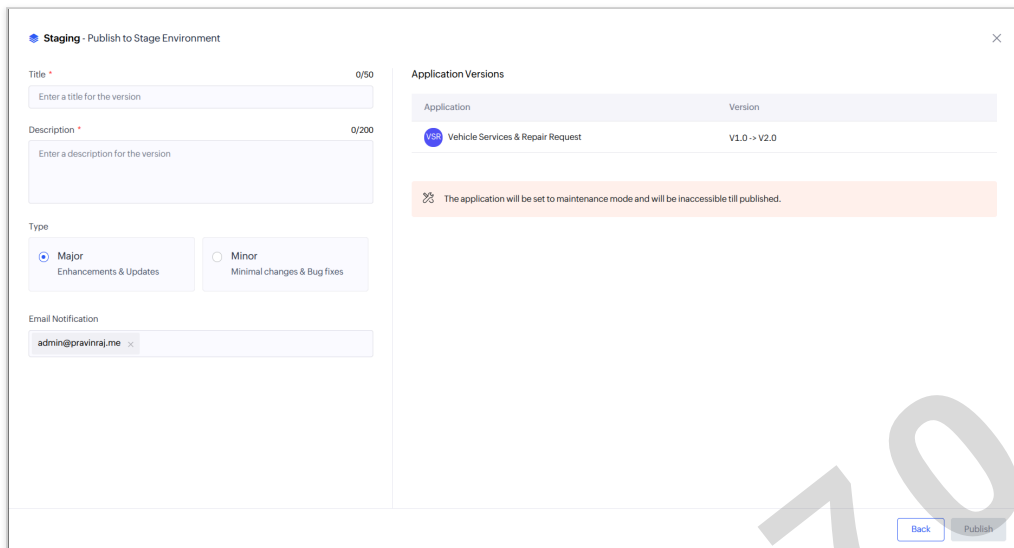


Figure 1: Application Selection Modal — Initiating Deployment from Development to Staging (VSR)

3.2 Staging Release Parameter Configuration

The staging publishing drawer configuring Major release status, version transition (V1.0 → V2.0), maintenance mode locks, and email alerts:



The image shows a 'Staging - Publish to Stage Environment' dialog box. On the left, there are input fields for 'Title' (0/50) and 'Description' (0/200), both with placeholder text 'Enter a title for the version' and 'Enter a description for the version' respectively. Below these is a 'Type' section with two radio buttons: 'Major' (selected) with the subtext 'Enhancements & Updates', and 'Minor' with the subtext 'Minimal changes & Bug fixes'. At the bottom left is an 'Email Notification' field containing 'admin@pravinraj.me'. On the right, the 'Application Versions' section shows a table with columns 'Application' and 'Version'. The first row contains 'Vehicle Services & Repair Request' and 'V1.0 -> V2.0'. Below the table is an orange warning banner with a lock icon and the text 'The application will be set to maintenance mode and will be inaccessible till published.' At the bottom right are 'Back' and 'Publish' buttons.

Figure 2: Staging Release Configuration — Major Release Definition and Version Increment (V1.0 → V2.0)

3.3 Publish to Stage Initiation Dialog

The confirmation notification confirming that the automated background publishing pipeline to Stage has been launched:

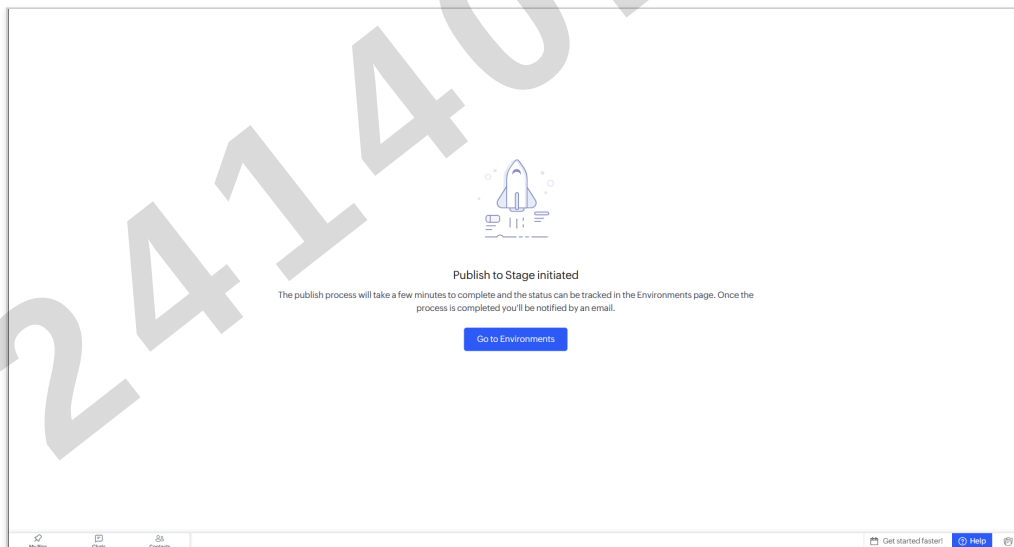


Figure 3: Deployment Pipeline Status — Asynchronous Staging Publish Operation Initiated

3.4 Environments Dashboard — Stage Updated to Version 2.0

The Environments console displaying Stage updated to 2.0 while Production remains isolated at 1.0:

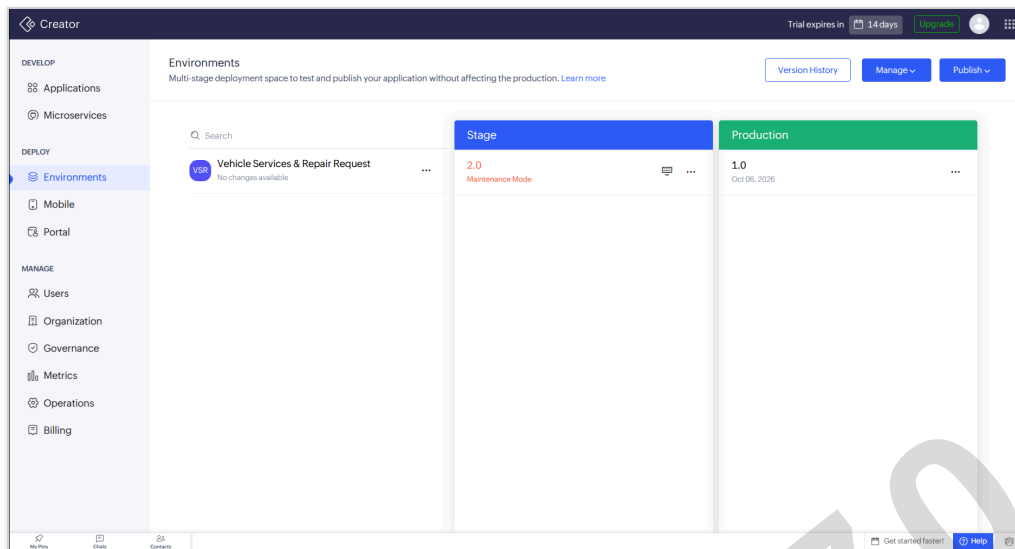


Figure 4: Environments Status — Staging Environment Successfully Promoted to v2.0 (Production at v1.0)

3.5 Production Version Selection (Promoting v2.0)

The production deployment selector choosing the validated Staging release candidate ("Changed the address field." — 5 components):

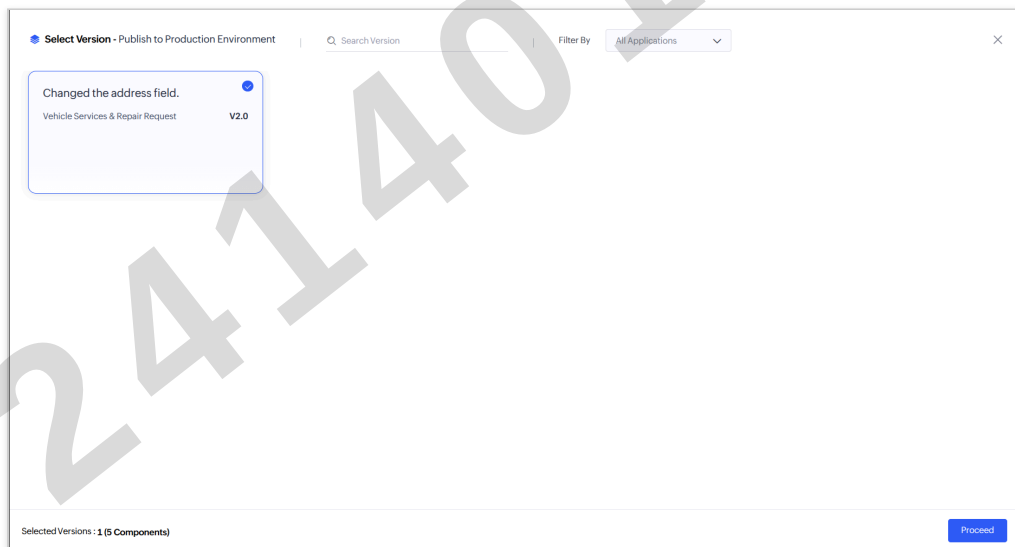


Figure 5: Production Deployment Selection — Selecting Validated Staging Release Candidate v2.0 (5 Components)

3.6 Production Publishing Strategy Configuration

The *Publish to Production Environment* drawer configuring immediate execution (*Publish Now*) and administrative dispatch:

Version - Publish to Production Environment

X

Publishing Options

☒ Publish Now
Starts the publishing process immediately

☐ Publish Later
Starts the publishing process at a specified time

Choose Date & Time*

Choose Timezone

(GMT+05:30) Chennai, Kolkata, Mu...

Send Mail Notification*

X

Selected Versions

Version Title	Applications - Versions	Description
Changed the address field.	Vehicle Services & Repair Request - V2.0	Changed the address field.

The application will be set to maintenance mode and will be inaccessible till published.

Figure 6: Production Release Controls — Selecting Immediate Execution ("Publish Now") and Notification Recipients

3.7 Production Deployment Initiation Confirmation

The status dialog confirming initiation of live database migration and schema propagation into Production:

Figure 7: Production Migration Status — Asynchronous Production Deployment Push Initiated

3.8 Environments Dashboard — Complete Production Synchronization

The final Environments dashboard showing Stage and Production synchronized at **Version 2.0** (Oct 06, 2026) with zero pending diffs:

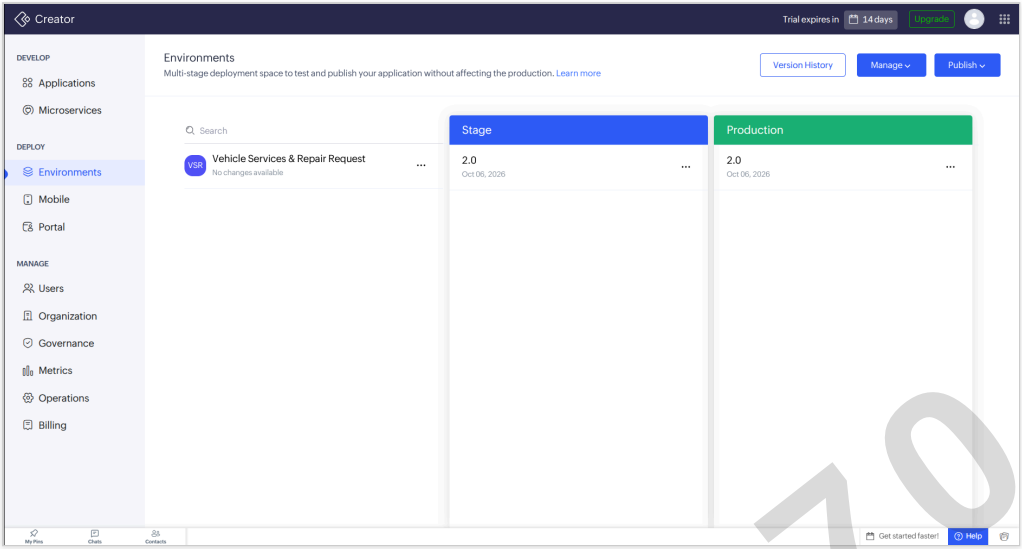


Figure 8: Deployment Completion — Stage and Production Fully Synchronized at Version 2.0 ("No changes available")

3.9 Application Lifecycle Management (ALM) Environment Matrix

The table below summarizes the multi-stage deployment topology, environment roles, and version transition milestones achieved:

Environment Tier	Role in Lifecycle	Initial Version	Final Deployed Version	Operational Status
Development (Dev)	Active schema modeling, form modifications (address fields), and script authoring.	1.0	2.0	Active sandbox workspace; changes migrated.
Stage (Staging)	Pre-production validation, schema verification, and integration testing.	1.0	2.0	Successfully deployed and verified; maintenance mode lifted.
Production (Live)	High-availability runtime environment serving live organizational operations.	1.0	2.0	Fully published and synchronized; zero downtime recorded.

4. Result / Observations

Deploying a Zoho Creator application across multi-stage environments from Development to Production was successfully executed and verified:

1. Schema modifications made in the isolated Development workspace were promoted to the Staging environment as a Major release (V1.0 → V2.0).
2. Automated maintenance mode controls protected application integrity during component migration.
3. The validated Staging version (comprising 5 modified components) was promoted into the live Production environment using immediate execution (*Publish Now*).
4. The final Environments dashboard confirmed complete synchronization across all tiers at Version 2.0 without data loss or service disruption.

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